

The BUILD Act: Pro-Climate Housing in Action

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Overview

Illinois is facing a serious housing shortage that is making housing more expensive for working and middle class families. Illinois is already short **142,000 homes** and **needs to build over 225,000 homes by 2030**. This is fueling an affordability crisis. It is also leading to increased pollution. By embracing the pro-climate zoning and land use reform policies in the BUILD Act, Illinois policymakers can make strides towards addressing both problems at once.

Read More:



In Senate District 56



26%

of income spent
on housing



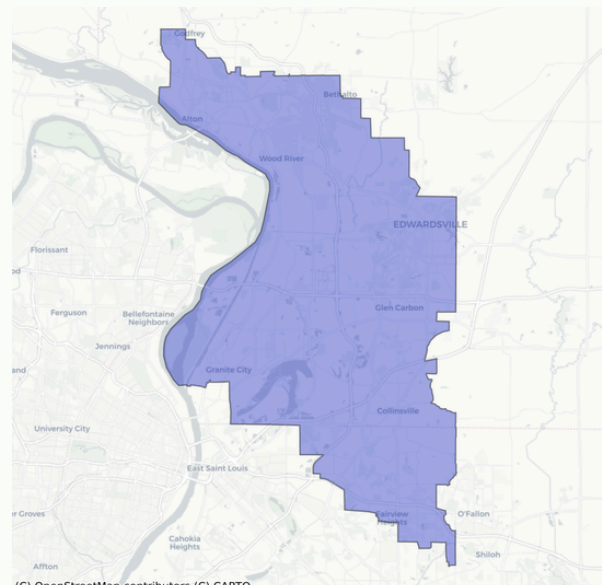
24%

avg. increase in
home value,
2020-2024



17%

avg. increase in
rent, 2020-2024



The BUILD Act contains the following key housing policies that will lower families' bills and reduce pollution:

- Eliminating parking minimums
- Legalizing “middle housing” and related zoning reforms
- Building code reform
- Modernizing permitting
- Facilitating Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs)
- Cutting red tape for rooftop solar and other clean energy retrofits

Sources: US Census Bureau ACS 5-Year 2020 and 2024; Housing and Transportation (H+T[®]) Affordability Index

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Illinois has a chance to showcase true leadership in building pro-climate housing.

Thanks to passing the Northeastern Illinois Transit Authority Act, our state is in a uniquely strong position to reduce pollution by building more housing in walkable, bikeable, and transit-served communities.

In addition to the climate benefits, building more housing has been shown to reduce costs on first-time buyers and renters. Pro-climate zoning reforms are not a panacea – other measures to promote stabilization and investments in affordable housing are also important. But studies have shown that these [types of policies](#) can go a long way towards **reducing pollution, tackling climate change, and lowering bills all at the same time.**



Illinois is not building enough housing to keep up with demand. New housing construction collapsed starting in the early 2000s due to a combination of municipalities adopting restrictive zoning codes, economic crises, and then later the pandemic. Now, Illinois has too few housing units for all the families who want to live here.

Right now, Illinois policymakers are facing two choices. Continuing with the status quo means that housing costs and pollution will both keep rising. Embracing pro-climate zoning will allow our state to become a leader addressing both at once.

Link: <https://climatecabineteducation.org/housing-policy-that-solves-climate-change/>